

# Rolling Home to Old Maewo

Trad., rewritten by Lew Toulmin in 2016

from “Rolling Down to Old Maui”; Bari uke chords added 4/2021; DUDU, bass, or single

It's a [Am] darned tough [C] life, full of toil and  
[Em] strife  
We [F] women chiefs [Am] undergo.  
We [Am] don't even care, when a [F] cyclone's  
rife,  
[C] How hard the wind does [Am] blow.  
We're [C] homeward bound! 'Tis a [G] grand  
old sound!  
Our [Am] Big Sista will [G] go,  
[Am] And all we care, [C] is for our island fair  
Our [F] long, sweet [G] home: [Am] Maewo.

*Chorus:*

*Rolling [C] down to old [G] Maewo, me gals,  
Rolling [Am] down to old [Em] Maewo  
We're [Am] homeward bound [C] to our  
sacred [Em] ground  
Rolling [F] home to [G] old [Am] Maewo.*

Once [Am] more we [C] sail with a southerly  
[Em] gale  
Through [F] the wind and waves and [Am] rain.  
And [Am] those coconut [F] palms in that  
tropical vale  
[C] We soon shall see [Am] again.  
For six [C] long months we've [G] been found  
[Am] In old Port Vila, [G] so  
Now [Am] we're bound from the capital [C]  
ground,  
[F] Rolling home [G] to old [Am] Maewo.

*Chorus*

How [Am] soft the [C] breeze of the tropical  
[Em] seas  
And [F] Efate's far [Am] astern,  
Our [Am] local blades in [F] those island [Am]  
glades  
[C] Are waiting our [Am] return.  
Every [C] day they yell, on [G] their cell,  
hoping [Am] some day to [G] know  
[Am] That our ship will sail, [C] before the gale  
[F] Rolling down [G] to old [Am] Maewo.

*Chorus*

Our [Am] kava brew [C] and our lap-lap [Em]  
too  
Are [F] the pride of each island [Am] chief  
Women [Am] chiefs are few, but our [F] hearts  
are true,  
[C] And our magic wards off [Am] grief.  
We [C] know our power, this [G] is our hour,  
To [Am] the top we'll [G] go.  
[Am] We're rolling down [C] to our chiefly  
ground  
[F] Sailing home [G] to old [Am] Maewo!

*Chorus*

We'll [Am] have a [C] feast of a sacred [Em]  
beast,  
With [F] his tusks so white and [Am] round.  
We'll [Am] right all wrongs, and [F] sing our  
songs,  
[C] on our hallowed village [Am] ground.  
When we [C] shed the gore of that [G] sacred  
boar,  
We'll [Am] love and kiss our [G] beaux.  
[Am] With ancient lore, women [C] chiefs will  
roar:  
[F] Our fiefdom: [G] old [Am] Maewo!

*Chorus*

Note: This song was composed for the  
Explorers Club Flag Expedition to Maewo  
island in the Republic of Vanuatu in 2016,  
which located and documented the previously  
unknown Female Chiefs of Vanuatu. See  
[www.themosttraveled.com](http://www.themosttraveled.com) for details.